

18+

EIGHT COUNTS AFTER DARK



AN ADULT PERFORMANCE DRAMA

T. K. ARVEN



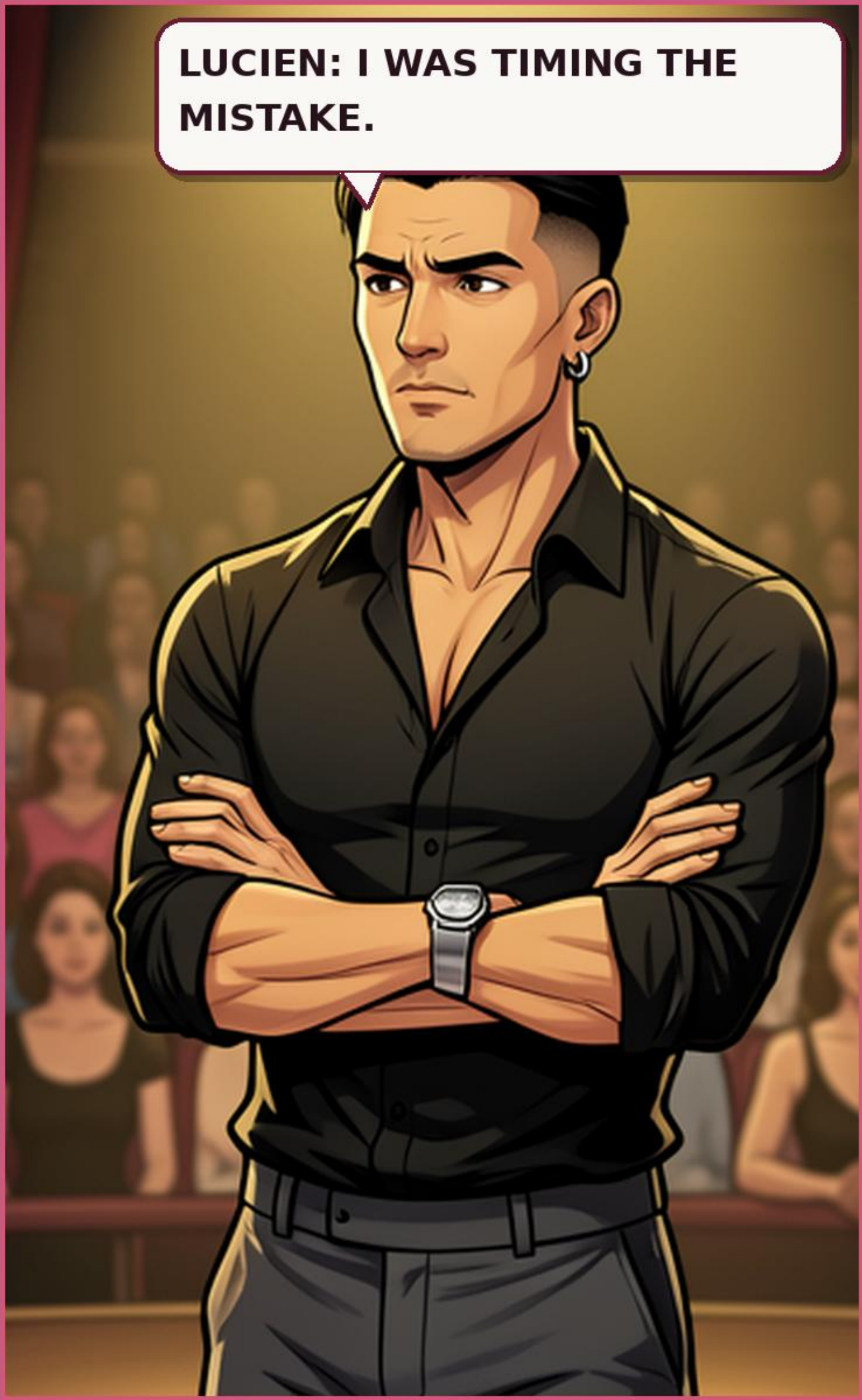
EIGHT COUNTS AFTER DARK

ADULTS 18+ · EPISODE ONE: THE CONTRACT

THE MARROW. OPEN AUDITIONS. 6:40 P.M.



ZARA: TRY NOT TO BLINK.



LUCIEN: I WAS TIMING THE MISTAKE.



HIS TURN.

ZARA: HE DANCES LIKE EVERY MIRROR OWES HIM MONEY.



CELESTE: ONE RESIDENCY. ONE NAME. MAKE ME REMEMBER YOURS.



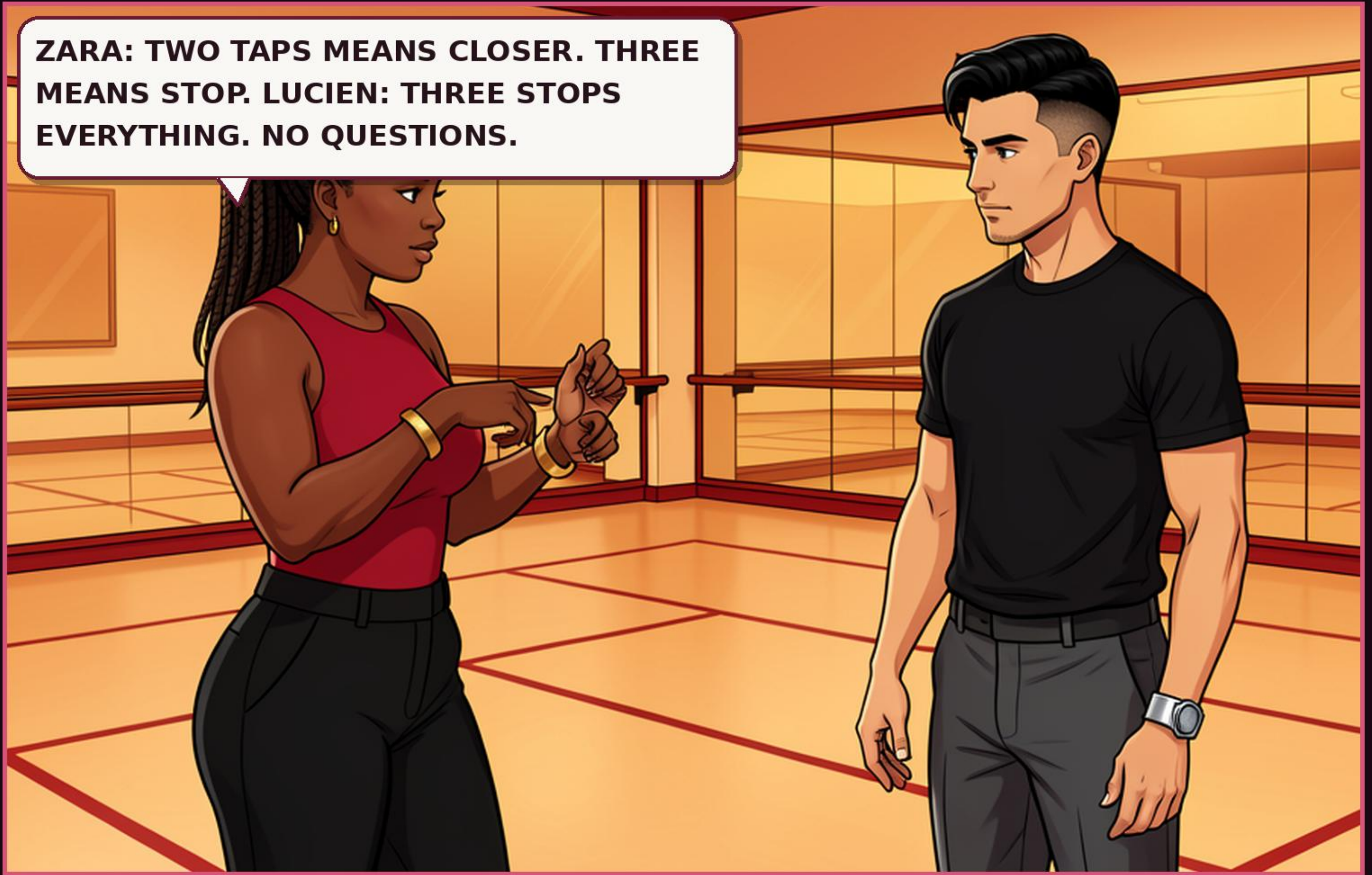


**ZARA: YOU COUNT LIKE A METRONOME
WITH A GRUDGE. LUCIEN: YOU IMPROVISE
LIKE RENT IS OPTIONAL.**

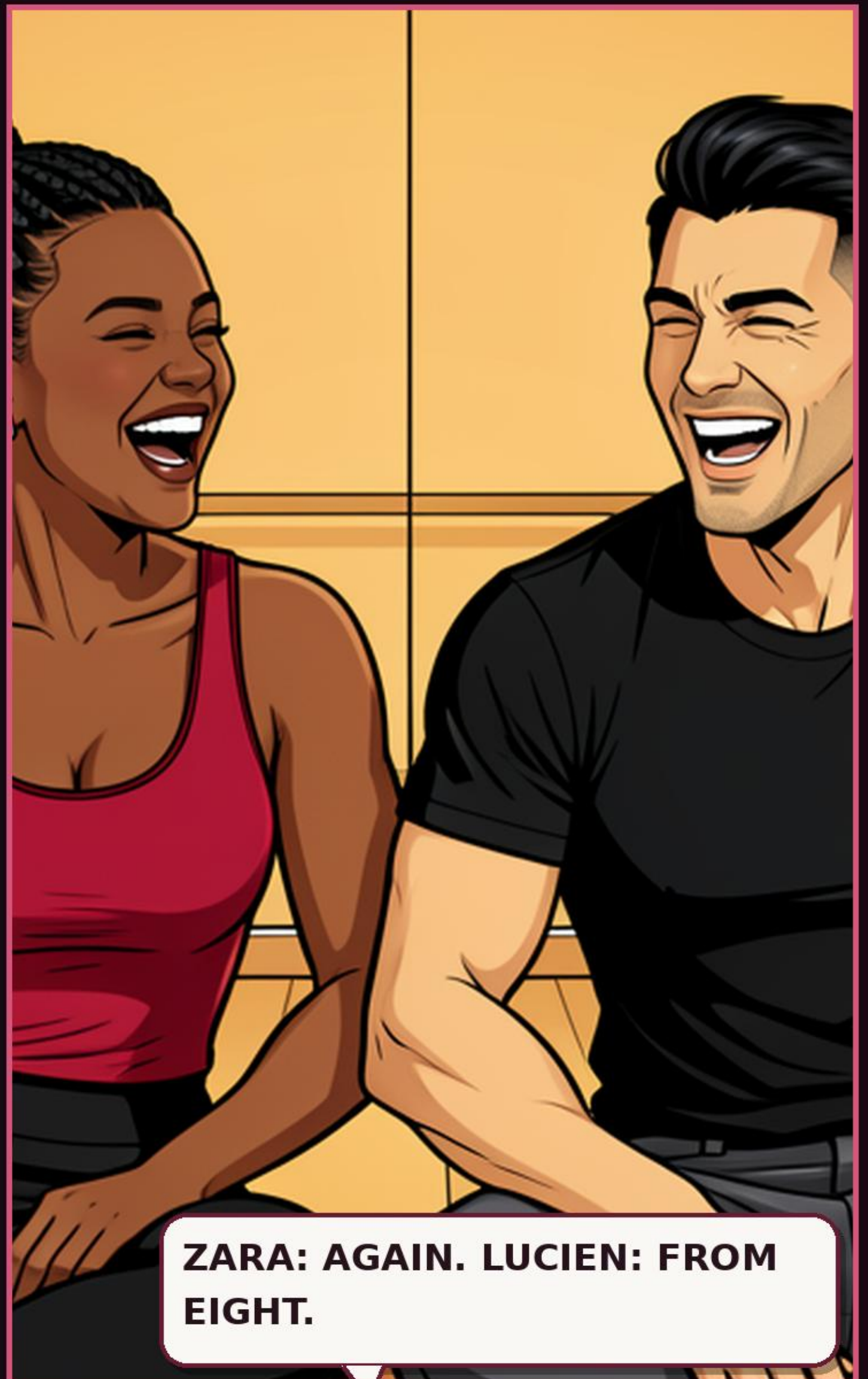


**CELESTE: GOOD. NOW AUDITION
TOGETHER.**

ZARA: TWO TAPS MEANS CLOSER. THREE MEANS STOP. LUCIEN: THREE STOPS EVERYTHING. NO QUESTIONS.



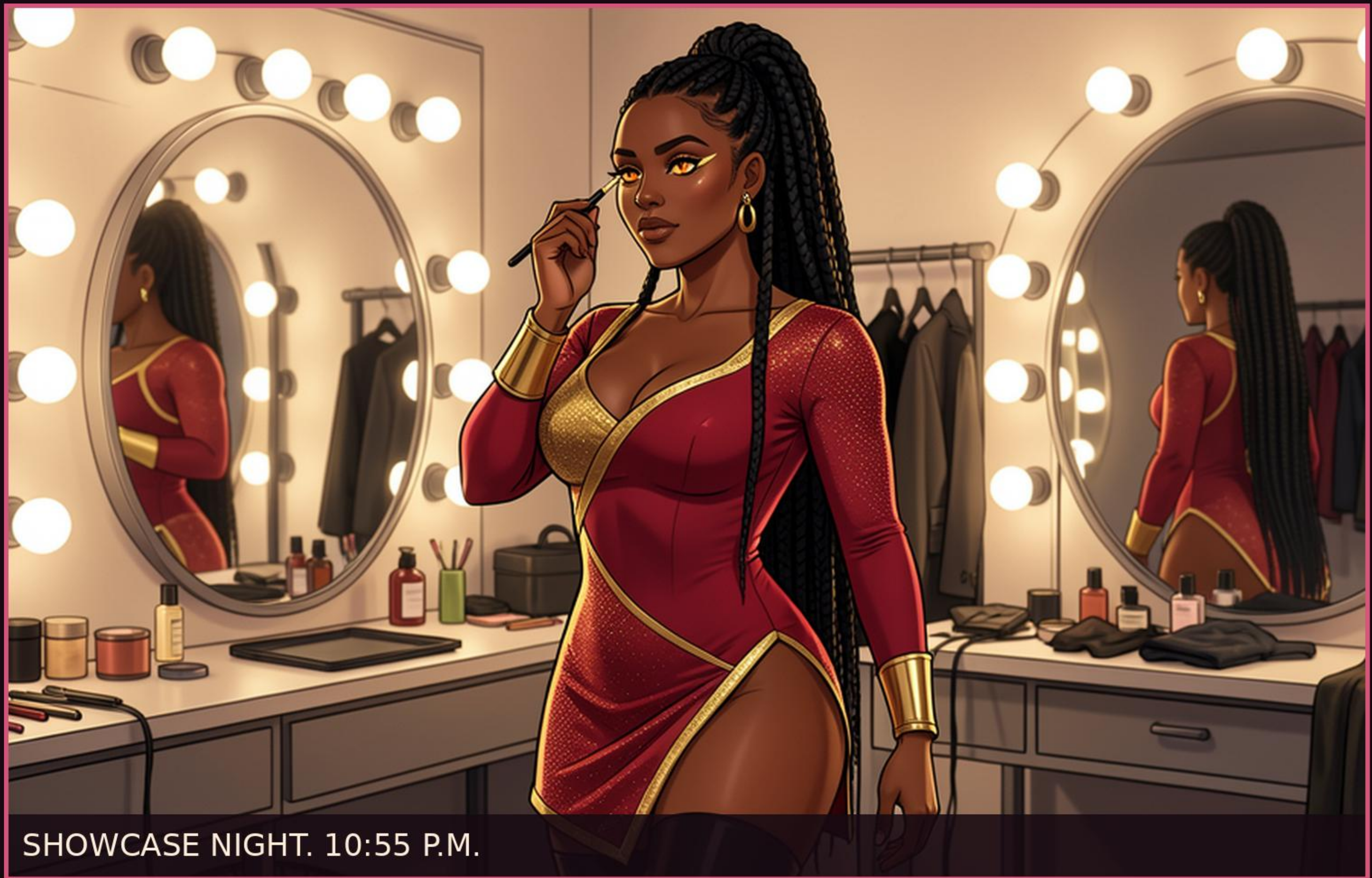
**ZARA: YOU MOVED EARLY.
LUCIEN: YOU HESITATED.**



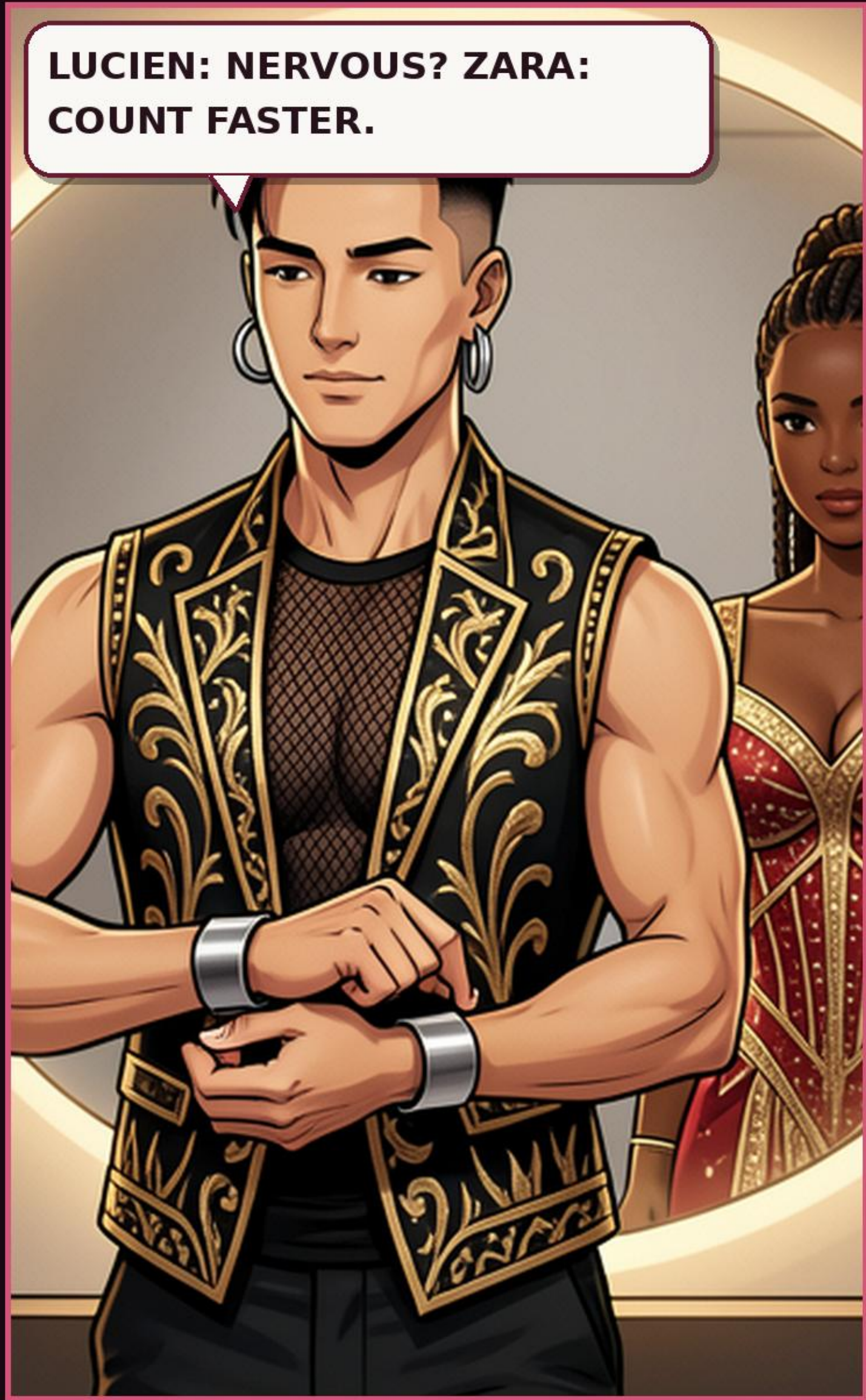
ZARA: AGAIN. LUCIEN: FROM EIGHT.



BY REHEARSAL SIX, THE ARGUMENT HAD LEARNED RHYTHM.



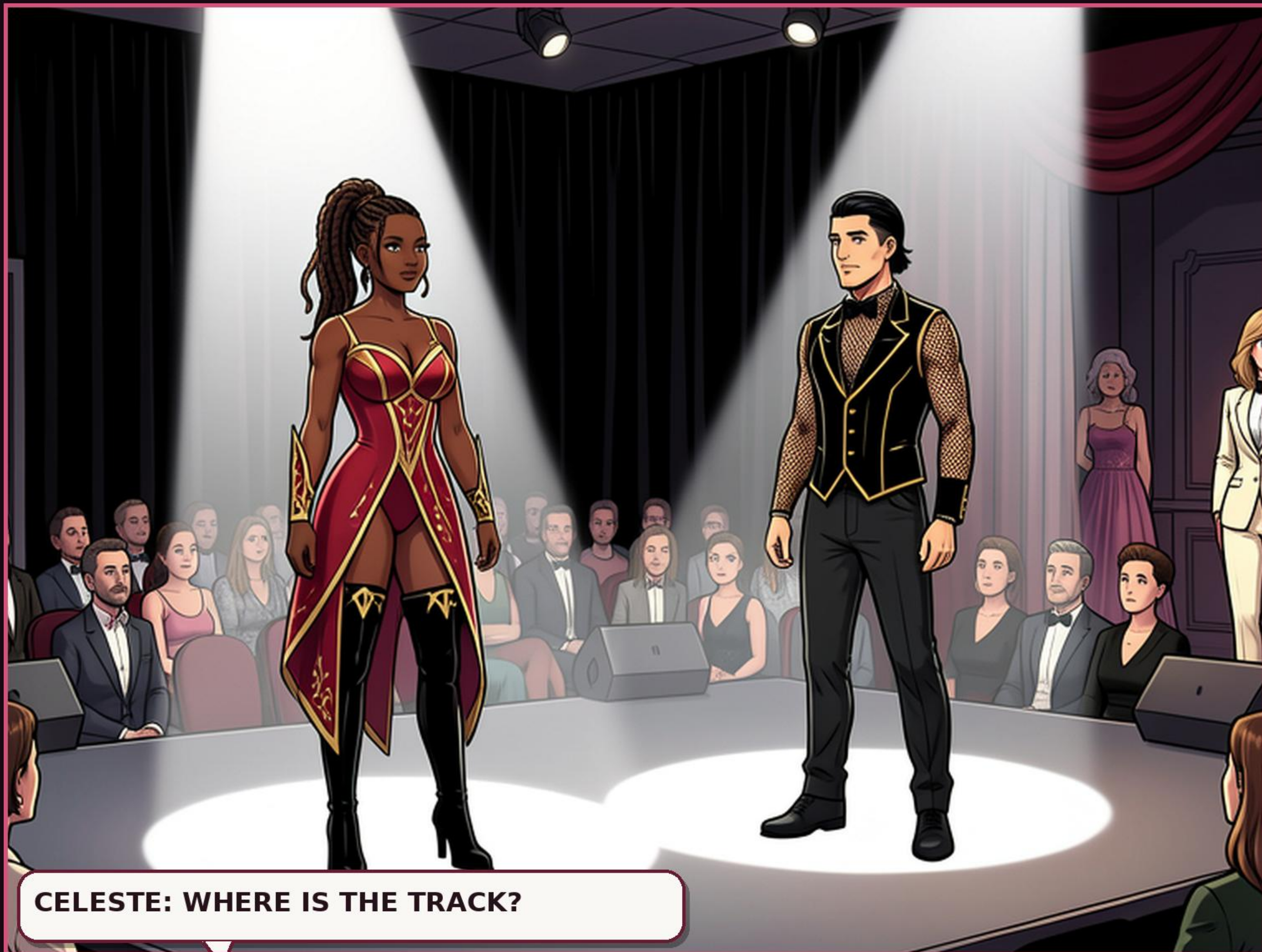
SHOWCASE NIGHT. 10:55 P.M.



LUCIEN: NERVOUS? ZARA:
COUNT FASTER.



SFX: SNAP.



CELESTE: WHERE IS THE TRACK?



**ZARA: FIVE, SIX, SEVEN—TRUST ME.
LUCIEN: ON EIGHT.**



THEY MADE BREATH, SHOES, AND HEARTBEAT THE MUSIC.



LUCIEN: TWO? ZARA: TWO.



CELESTE: ONE CONTRACT.
TWO NAMES.

SOMEONE ELSE HAD COUNTED ON
THEM FAILING.